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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1958-1966

Coverage Date: 1958-1966

Place Coverage: G/Wi, Ghanzi District, Botswana

Section Title(S): Joking And Respect

A joking or an avoidance/respect relationship is tied to each kinship term (except husband and wife). The terms in a joking relationship are:

babama (grandfather)*mamasa* (grandmother)*n//odima* (grandson, male cross-cousin)*n//odisa* (granddaughter, female cross-cousin)*g#w'a'usa* (sister-in-law, potential wife)*gjiba:xuma* (younger brother)*gija:xuma* (elder brother)[601](#)[Kinship Terminology](#)[602](#)[Kin Relationships](#)

For avoidance/respect relationships the terms are:

ba:ma (father)*gje:sa* (mother)*ba:g/wama* (little father)*gje:g/wasa* (little mother)*gjiba:xusa* (younger sister)*gija:xusa* (elder sister)*g/wāma* (son)[601](#)[Kinship Terminology](#)[602](#)[Kin Relationships](#)

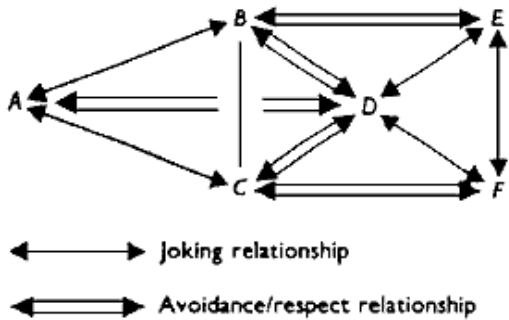
g/ wāsa (daughter)

(This is appropriate to a male ego; in the case of a female ego, the joking/respect statuses of siblings are transposed and their term *gʷa'usa* is replaced by its masculine equivalent, *gʷa'uma* [brother-in-law, potential husband]. The translations include classificatory as well as real categories. The terms "little father" and "little mother" are literal translations of those terms used for, respectively, real and classificatory father's brother and mother's sister's husband, and mother's sister, father's brother's wife.)

In categorizing kin into joking or avoidance/respect relationships, symmetry is maintained so that (with the exceptions discussed below) any individual has the same type of relationship with a third person as does his joking partner. In a series of triads, the triangles are congruent (Figure 8); joking partners *A* and *B* also have a joking relationship with *C*. A congruent triangle of joking relationships similarly exists between *D*, *E*, and *F*. The avoidance/respect relationships between *A* and *D* is matched by

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Figure 8. Joking and avoidance/respect relationships among six persons, designated *A* to *F*.



similar relationships between *A*'s joking partners and those of *D*. This principle of congruency is coupled with an alternation of generations, for example, the parent-child avoidance that exists between Ego and his father and between his father and *his* father contrasts with the joking relationship between Ego and his paternal grandfather (Figures 9–12). In turn, Ego is in an avoidance relationship with his great-grandfather, should the old man still be alive.

Human Relations Area Files
755 Prospect Street
New Haven, CT 06511
General Inquiries: [✉ hraf@yale.edu](mailto:hraf@yale.edu)
Issues and Bugs: [✉ hraf-support@yale.edu](mailto:hraf-support@yale.edu)



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